

Parshas Bamidbar

תשע"ט - במדבר פרשת

Rabbi Shalom Rosner ♦ 5779

Sefer Bamidbar holds a central paradox: *how do we find order in the wilderness?* Each of the six highlights below traces a thread of Rabbi Rosner's answer.

1 • Every Sefer Has Its Own Soul

The *Rishonim* each offer a distinct lens. Bamidbar is *Chumash HaPekudim* — the Book of Countings — yet far more than a census. It spans **year one** through **year forty** with nearly thirty-eight silent years between.

עצמו, בפני ענין לו יש ספר כל
מיוחדת. ותכלית עצמות

Opening — 0:00

2 • Bitachon Unlocks Torah

Trust in God leads to deeper Torah understanding because Torah cannot be acquired through intellect alone — Hashem must open the gates. The *midbar* strips away every crutch, leaving only Hashem.

הבטחון מדת
התורה. להבנת מביאה

4:08 — Darkei Mussar

3 • Order Within the Wilderness

Midbar is *hefker* — ownerless, formless. **Pekudim** is the opposite: each person counted, each tribe placed, each flag raised. That is the sefer's challenge.

דגלו. על ואיש מחנהו על איש - וסדר ארגון של המבנה ביטוי הוא המפקד

"To have order in *hefkerus*. To be in a *makom hefker*, and yet be *mufkad* — counted, known, placed." 19:56

4 • Flags Like Angels — Love Made Visible

Why flags? Flags are *physical*; angels are spiritual. The Midrash finds the answer in *Shir HaShirim*: “His banner over me is love.” The flag is not military — it is an expression of Hashem’s love, making each tribe **recognisable**.

חֲבֵן גְּדוּלָּה חֲבָה
הוּא בְּרוּךְ הַקְדוּשָׁה
דְּגָלִים שֶׁעֲשָׂאָם
הַשְׂרִית כְּמִלְאָכִי
נִכְרִים. שְׁיֵהוּ כְּדִי

39:54 — *Midrash Rabbah*

5 • No Star Without a Purpose

Every tribe has its own gift. Every Jew — like every star — was created for a **specific, unrepeatable mission**. Some excel in *tefillah*, some in Torah, some in *chesed*. None is redundant.

מִטָּרָה. בְּלֹא כּוֹכָב אֵין
נִבְרָא. שְׁלִשְׁמוֹ מִיּוֹחַד וְתִפְקִיד יְעוּד יֵשׁ כּוֹכָב לְכָל
קִמּוֹ (תְּהִלִּים) יִקְרָא. שִׁמּוֹת לְכָל־ם - לְכוֹכְבִּים מִסְפֵּר מוֹנֶה

“The second we were born was when Hashem decided the world **cannot exist without us** anymore.” 40:01

6 • The Silence of the Sdei Chemed

A young scholar in Bukhara — later the *Sdei Chemed* — was falsely accused. He chose **silence** over vindication. From that moment his learning soared. To be *mevater* — to yield what is rightfully yours — may be the greatest *zechus* we can offer.
“From the moment he decided to remain silent, he began to see extraordinary success in his studies.”

פִּיּוֹ אֶת הַכּוֹבֵשׁ
דְּשִׁמְיָא לְסִיעֵתָא זֹכָה
בְּלִמּוּדוֹ.

Sdei Chemed, 1834–1905

סִינִי בַּמִּדְבָּר אֶל-מֹשֶׁה ה' וַיְדַבֵּר

“And Hashem spoke to Moshe in the Wilderness of Sinai.” (Bamidbar 1:1)